

FREEWAY CLOSURE DEEPENS STRAIN

California shuts I-5 after military confirms live artillery would be shot over it for event.

By Andrew J. Campa, Melody Gutierrez, Karen Garcia and Malia Mendez

Gridlock reigned Saturday on one of California's most vital freeways after state officials closed a 17-mile stretch of Interstate 5 in response to a planned event in which live-fire artillery rounds were shot over the freeway at Camp Pendleton.

The full closure of the main route between Los Angeles and San Diego was brief, but it caused massive traffic jams across San Diego and Orange counties. Exits from the freeway onto surface streets were clogged. Many motorists were forced to take a jammed Interstate 15. The inland detour swelled drive times from L.A. to San Diego to well over three hours as of Saturday afternoon. That was an hourlong delay during typical conditions.

The closure marked another clash between the Trump administration and Democratic Gov. Gavin Newsom.

Newsom criticized the White House for failing to coordinate or share safety information ahead of the Marine Corps 250th anniversary celebration, which featured Vice President JD Vance.

"It is not safe for people to drive on a major freeway at high speeds directly under LIVE MUNITIONS," his office wrote on X. "White House not communicating, endangering the public, and then trying to blame the Governor for doing the right thing — keeping people out of harm's way — yet another day living in Trump's authoritarian America," the post said.

Administration officials said the Camp Pendleton event was safe and that a [See Closure, A11]



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times



NATHAN HOWARD Getty Images

TOP, A DEMONSTRATOR in face paint and a costume who calls himself Dandidi advocates for liberty at the "No Kings" protest Saturday in L.A. Above, participants march along Pennsylvania Avenue during the rally in Washington.

ACROSS THE U.S.: Many communities, big and small, speaking out. **NATION, A9**

'No Kings' protests draw huge crowds

Tens of thousands denounce Trump in Southland amid mass rallies nationwide.

By Christopher Buchanan, Jack Flemming and Hannah Fry

Tens of thousands of protesters took to the streets across Southern California on Saturday for "No Kings" demonstrations against President Trump, portraying the commander in chief as an aspiring monarch as he continues to engage in what critics argue is government overreach.

In Grand Park, protesters gathered under the shade of a 20-foot inflatable of Trump in a diaper as a band belted out an Epstein files-themed parody of Johnny Cash's "Folsom Prison Blues." Protesters draped in LGBTQ+, Mexican and American flags held signs that read "Liberty," "No Kings" and "Veto The Cheeto."

"We're here to fight fascism, and we're not afraid," said 25-year-old Jess Sanchez, who has had family members targeted in recent

immigration raids. "This is our city and our country."

The gathering in Grand Park was just one of thousands that unfolded across the country on Saturday as part of a nationwide effort to push back not only against the president, but his administration's policies on immigration, education, healthcare and environmental protections.

More than 2,700 "No Kings" demonstrations were scheduled across the country, roughly 600 more events than in June. Demonstrations in New York, Chicago, Atlanta and Boston drew massive crowds.

In June, roughly 5 million demonstrators rallied across the nation for the first "No Kings" protests as the Trump administration's agenda began coming into focus. At that time, the Department of Homeland Security had begun carrying out large-scale immigration raids across Southern California, and Trump deployed military troops to Los Angeles in response to mass protests.

Since then, many Americans believe that Trump's actions — doubling down on immigration raids in major cities, deploying National [See Protests, A9]

San Francisco scoffs at troop threat

President's 'mess' remark draws outrage and eye-rolls from locals and leaders.

By Kevin Rector

SAN FRANCISCO — About 24 hours after President Trump declared San Francisco such a crime-ridden "mess" that he was recommending federal forces be sent to restore order, Mani Limlamai, 43, and Kai

Saetern, 32, rolled their eyes at the suggestion.

The pair — both in the software industry — were with friends Thursday in Dolores Park, a vibrant green space with sweeping views of downtown, playing volleyball under a blue sky and autumn sun. All around them, people sat on benches with books, flew kites, played with dogs or otherwise lounged away the afternoon on blankets in the grass.

Both Limlamai and Saetern said San Francisco of course has issues, and

some rougher neighborhoods — but that's any city.

"I've lived here for 10 years and I haven't felt unsafe, and I've lived all over the city," Saetern said. "Every city has its problems, and I don't think San Francisco is any different," but "it's not a hellscape," said Limlamai, who has been in the city since 2021.

Both said Trump's suggestion that he might send in troops was more alarming than reassuring — especially, Limlamai said, on top of his recent remark that

American cities should serve as "training grounds" for U.S. military forces.

"I don't think that's appropriate at all," he said. "The military is not trained to do what needs to be done in these cities."

Across San Francisco, residents, visitors and prominent local leaders expressed similar ideas — if not much sharper condemnation of any troop deployment. None shied away from the fact that San Francisco has problems, especially [See San Francisco, A13]

Smash that like button, then buy, buy, buy

By Wendy Lee and Caroline Petrow-Cohen

Inside a historic aircraft hangar in Playa Vista, crowds of people gathered on Thursday to browse the latest fashions from handbags to clothing and shoes as they prepared for the holiday shopping season.

These weren't shoppers or retailer buyers searching for the latest products. Instead, they were YouTube video creators who were being courted by brands from REI to Shark Beauty to encourage online audiences to buy their products.

Aaron Ramirez, a 22-year-old influencer who focuses on men's fashion and lifestyle, stood in front of racks of carefully curated shelves of backpacks as he decided which items he would endorse for his 234,000 YouTube subscribers.

"I can make a video about anything that improves my quality of life and add a link to it," said Ramirez. "I only recommend products that I really use and really like."

The San Diego resident was among about 300 creators participating in YouTube's annual benefit for creators dubbed "Holiday House" that helps internet personalities get ready to sell goods during the busy holiday shopping season.

The event — held at the cavernous converted Google offices that once housed Howard Hughes' famous Spruce Goose plane — underscores YouTube's desire to be a bigger player in online shopping by leveraging its relationship with creators to promote products in much the same way that rival TikTok does.

In August, YouTube introduced new tools to help its creators better promote [See YouTube, A16]

Voices **BILL PLASCHKE** COLUMNIST

Greatest Sho on Earth is right here

In a career of doing the improbable, Ohtani achieves the seemingly impossible.

One minute he was burning through the top of the first inning with three flaming strikeouts. *Roar!* The next minute — literally — he was slugging

through the bottom of the first by driving a ball 446 feet into the back of the right-field pavilion.

Roar! Roar! Three innings later he was doing it again, striking out two batters in the top of the fourth inning before driving a ball 469 feet over the roof of the same right-field pavilion.

Roar! Roar! Roar! Then in the seventh inning after he had left the mound after six scoreless, [See Plaschke, A10]

DODGERS ADVANCE: "Ultimate unicorn" stars as they sweep past Brewers into Fall Classic. **SPORTS, D1**

Israel won't reopen Gaza crossing yet

Delay in unsealing the gateway to Egypt adds pressure on Hamas over hostages' remains. **WORLD, A3**

Is Pelosi getting Biden treatment?

High intraparty drama emerges in the scramble for her congressional seat. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Mostly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 83/57. **B8**

Opinion Voices **A18**
Obituaries **B5**

Is Sombr in it for the long haul?

Hit debut album brings sudden stardom. Can he "stay in the music"? **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

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NICK DANIELSON

SPANISH ATHLETE Kilian Jornet, who once climbed Mt. Everest twice in a week, recently climbed 72 summits over 14,000 feet in the contiguous U.S.

COLUMN ONE

Peaking, 31 days in a row

Mountaineering pro completes monthlong marathon

By Jack Dolan

Kilian Jornet, one of the world's most accomplished mountaineers, did something this month that left even other elite athletes gasping: He climbed all 72 summits in the contiguous United States that stand over 14,000 feet tall. In 31 days.

That's like climbing California's Mt. Whitney — the nation's tallest mountain outside of Alaska — two and a half times per day, every day, for a month.

But reaching so many summits, so quickly, was only half the battle. In fact, it was "the fun part," a surprisingly rested-looking Jornet said in a Zoom interview from Seattle earlier this month, three days after summiting Mt. Rainier in knee-deep snow to complete the grueling journey, which he started in early September.

The hard part was negotiating the spaces in between.

"If you're driving, you see the landscape," Jornet explained. "But you don't feel it."

[See Mountaineer, A12]